

Letting Go — A Practice ★ ELEVATED

DURATION	40 min · Week 5
OBJECTIVE	Students engage in a symbolic release practice and articulate why self-forgiveness is an ongoing practice, not a single event.
CASEL FOCUS	Self-Management: symbolic release and process understanding
VOCABULARY	release, practice, process, choose, ongoing, lighter
MATERIALS	Small stones or slips of paper · Journals · Reflection Pass pre-positioned at every seat

SAFETY CHECK — COMPLETE BEFORE DELIVERING

Counselor notified — minimum 1 week in advance. · Counselor reachable on the day. · Lesson NOT scheduled before a school break. · Reflection Pass pre-positioned at every seat. Monitor for students who interpret “letting go” language as about letting go of the SELF. If you hear “I want to get rid of myself,” STOP immediately and activate the Disclosure Protocol.

OPENING REVIEW

2 Minutes

“Last lesson we wrote letters to ourselves. Today we practice actually putting something down. Not forgetting. Not saying it was fine. Just choosing not to carry it the same way anymore.”

ANCHOR CHART · THE STONE PRACTICE — GUIDED RELEASE VISUAL

Display this visual as you lead the practice. Walk through each step slowly. Students hold the stone through Steps 1-3, then place it down at Step 4. Give 30 seconds of silence. Do not rush this moment.

1

The Process Frame

2-9 MIN

Self-forgiveness is not a switch that flips. It is a practice you return to. Some things you put down dozens of times before they stay down. That is not failure — that is what the practice looks like.

2

The Stone Practice

9-18 MIN

Distribute small stones or slips of paper. Students write one thing they are ready to work on releasing. Guided release: “Hold what you wrote. I acknowledge what happened. I have done what repair is possible. I am choosing not to carry the weight of this the same way anymore.” Place the stone down. 30 seconds of silence.